

Strings in Python

Python is excellent for using words and sentences within programs. Different strings (sequences of characters) can be joined together, or individual parts of them can be selected and pulled out.

SEE ALSO

◀ **54–55** Strings and lists

◀ **110–111** Types of data

Creating a string

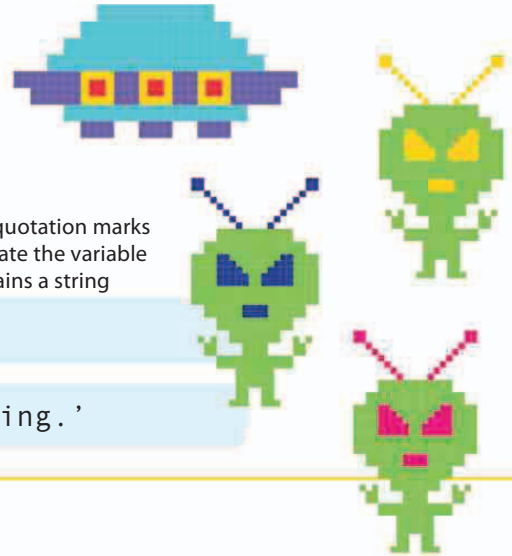
A string might include letters, numbers, symbols, or spaces. These are all called characters. Strings can be placed in variables.

▷ Strings in variables

Variables can store strings. Type these two strings into the variables “a” and “b”.

```
>>> a = 'Run!'
>>> b = 'Aliens are coming.'
```

The quotation marks indicate the variable contains a string



Adding strings

Adding two numbers together creates a new number. In the same way, when two strings are added together, one string simply joins on to the other one.

```
>>> c = a + b
>>> print(c)
Run! Aliens are coming.
```

The variables “a” and “b” combine to become variable “c”

△ Adding strings together

The “+” symbol joins one string to another. and the answer becomes the variable “c”.

```
>>> c = b + ' Watch out! ' + a
>>> print(c)
Aliens are coming. Watch out! Run!
```

A new string is added to variable “c”

△ Adding another string in between

A new string can also be added between two strings. Try the example above.

The new string appears in the middle of the message



EXPERT TIPS

Length of a string

The “len()” function is used to find out the length of a string. Python counts all of the characters, including spaces, to give the total number of characters in a string.

Calculates the length of the string in variable “a” (“Run!”)

```
>>> len(a)
4
>>> len(b)
18
```

The string in variable “b” (“Aliens are coming.”) is 18 characters long